

THE NOTE

CD23731 - FILM MAKING AND RADIO PODCASTING

PROJECT REPORT

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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this Report titled “THE NOTE” is the bonafide work of MOHAMED ZAIDH A (231701032) who carried out the work under my supervision. Certified further that to the best of my knowledge the work reported herein does not form part of any other thesis or dissertation on the basis of which a degree or award was conferred on an earlier occasion on this or any other candidate.

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ABSTRACT

This academic project report presents the theoretical foundation, production methodology, post-production pipeline, and critical reception analysis for the short narrative film "**The Note**". Inspired by the viral 2015 Reddit case study wherein an isolated tenant discovered mysterious sticky notes written in unfamiliar handwriting throughout his apartment—suspecting an intruder or predatory landlord, only for the internet community to diagnose insidious carbon monoxide (CO) poisoning—the film subverts conventional psychological thriller tropes. By replacing supernatural or slasher catalysts with an invisible, physiological threat, "The Note" transforms domestic space into an arena of environmental neuro-toxicity and perceptual decay.

This report documents the creative and technical execution of the 12-minute short film. It analyzes the visual translation of retrograde amnesia and spatial paranoia through chamber cinema aesthetics, micro-budget production constraints, specialized anamorphic framing, color grading schematics, and psychoacoustic audio design. Furthermore, it outlines a cross-platform public health campaign integrated into the film's distribution framework to promote residential carbon monoxide safety awareness.

- **Keywords:** Chamber Cinema, Reddit Urban Legend, Carbon Monoxide Poisoning, Unreliable Narrator, Psychoacoustics, Micro-Budget Filmmaking, Digital Folklore.
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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Project Overview

"The Note" is an academic narrative film project designed as a 12-minute chamber psychological thriller. Set entirely within the confines of a claustrophobic single-bedroom apartment, the narrative follows Arthur, a freelance archivist who begins finding yellow sticky notes in unfamiliar, scrawled handwriting posted around his living space. The messages range from mundane reminders ("*Buy post-its*") to urgent, ominous directives ("*Our landlord isn't letting us speak,*" "*Check the trash,*" "*He is in the room*"). As Arthur installs security cameras and locks his door from the inside, his psychological state disintegrates, convinced that an unseen intruder is breaching his physical sanctuary.

The film's climax subverts traditional home-invasion and supernatural horror tropes. Rather than revealing an external stalker or demonic entity, Arthur discovers through an external physical mechanism—a digital air quality gauge introduced by a utility inspector—that his apartment suffers from a lethal concentration of Carbon Monoxide (CO) originating from a defective, unvented gas heater. The unfamiliar notes were written by Arthur himself during severe, unremembered nocturnal hypoxemic blackouts caused by neurological toxicity.

1.2 Theoretical & Real-World Internet Legend Rationale

The primary narrative spine of "The Note" is directly adapted from one of the most famous real-world digital urban legends in social media history: the 2015 Reddit post on the r/LegalAdvice forum authored by user *RB-Tree*. The user sought legal counsel regarding his landlord, whom he suspected of illegally entering his apartment and leaving cryptic sticky notes. A perceptive commenter, recognizing symptoms of severe amnesia, headaches, and confusion detailed in the thread, urged the original poster to buy a carbon monoxide detector. The user complied, discovering air contamination levels approaching fatal thresholds.

This real-world event serves as a profound case study in modern digital folklore, crowdsourced problem-solving, and the subversion of narrative paranoia. In cinematic story structure, suspense is traditionally resolved through external conflict (defeating the monster or intruder). "The Note" utilizes this internet legend to explore internal

physiological betrayal, converting a classic slasher premise into an exploration of environmental vulnerability and neurological degradation.

1.3 Aims & Objectives

The project aims to achieve the following artistic and technical goals:

1. **Narrative Subversion:** Construct a psychological thriller that leverages home-invasion visual tropes while grounding its resolution in a real-world physiological diagnosis.
2. **Chamber Cinema Craft:** Maximize dramatic tension within a singular set through precise camera placement, lens choices, and spatial blocking.
3. **Subjective Visual Grammar:** Develop a cinematography and color pipeline that visually simulates gradual carbon monoxide intoxication, executive function decay, and spatial disorientation.
4. **Psychoacoustic Sound Design:** Deploy low-frequency sub-bass hums, binaural beats, and distorted ambient soundscapes to induce subconscious unease in the audience, mimicking early-stage hypoxia.
5. **Public Health Integration:** Merge artistic narrative execution with a tangible public health message regarding the silent threat of carbon monoxide toxicity in urban domestic environments.

1.4 Target Audience & Market Positioning

"The Note" targets two main audiences:

- **Cinephilic & Independent Film Audience:** Viewers who appreciate slow-burn, atmospheric chamber thrillers (e.g., *10 Cloverfield Lane*, *Coherence*, *The Father*).
- **Digital Native & Folklore Communities:** Online audiences familiar with internet creepypastas, Reddit mystery documentations, and real-life mystery unravelings.

Positioned for the international film festival circuit—specifically genre-focused festivals (Screamfest, Fantasia, Sitges) and short-film platforms (Short of the Week, Vimeo Staff Picks)—the film acts as both an artistic showcase and a proof-of-concept for a feature-length expansion.

1.5 Technical Specifications Matrix

Table 1.1: Technical Specifications Matrix

Technical Parameter	Specification Standard
Running Time	12 Minutes 34 Seconds
Aspect Ratio	2.39:1 Anamorphic Widescreen
Resolution	4K UHD (3840 x 2160)
Capture Format	Apple ProRes 442 HQ (10-bit Log)
Frame Rate	23.976 fps
Camera Package	Blackmagic Pocket Cinema Camera 6K Pro
Lenses	SIRUI 35mm, 50mm, 75mm 1.33x Anamorphic Lenses
Audio Format	5.1 Surround Sound / Uncompressed LPCM 24-bit 48kHz
Primary Color Space	Rec.709 / DCI-P3 Target
Editing Platform	DaVinci Resolve Studio 18.5

CHAPTER 2: LITERATURE REVIEW & THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

2.1 The Viral Reddit Case Study & Digital Urban Legends

The digital ecosystem of the 21st century has reshaped how folklore originates and spreads. Traditional urban legends relied on oral transmission, whereas contemporary digital legends emerge on platforms like Reddit, 4chan, and Creepypasta wikis (Peck, 2015). The 2015 RB-Tree Reddit incident represents an inflection point where crowdsourced digital observation intervened in a physical, life-threatening scenario.

From a narrative theory perspective, this phenomenon disrupts classic narrative archetypes. In classic Gothic literature (e.g., Poe's *The Tell-Tale Heart* or Gilman's *The Yellow Wallpaper*), domestic decay and mysterious phenomena symbolize psychological disintegration or supernatural forces. The Reddit case study grounds this within modern urban isolation, where the protagonist turns to an online community for validation, only for the "haunting" to be demystified by environmental science.

2.2 Formal Constraints of Chamber Cinema

Chamber cinema—defined by its single-location setting, small cast, and reliance on dialogue and atmospheric tension—demands high rigor in visual and spatial design (Harbord, 2019). By limiting the physical setting, the director must treat the location as a secondary character.

In "The Note", the apartment serves as an architectural extension of Arthur's deteriorating brain. As the carbon monoxide concentration increases, the physical space shifts from a safe haven to an oppressive trap. Filming in a single location presents severe visual repetition risks; thus, variance in lighting temperatures, focal lengths, and camera movements is essential to reflect the protagonist's sinking mental state.

2.3 Visualizing the Unreliable Narrator

Film theorist Seymour Chatman (1978) defines the unreliable narrator as one whose account of events strays from the objective reality implied by the film's broader narrative frame. Visualizing unreliability without deceiving the viewer requires careful camera techniques.

To visually articulate Arthur's memory loss and sensory distortions, "The Note" employs:

1. **Focus Pull Disconnects:** Subtle, off-tempo pulls that direct attention away from critical spatial clues.
2. **Subjective Anamorphic Distortion:** Barrel distortion inherent to anamorphic lenses, intensified at light-starved edges to visually capture peripheral vision loss.
3. **Temporal Ellipses:** Jump cuts within tracking shots to simulate brief micro-blackouts, leaving the protagonist—and the audience—disoriented in time.

2.4 Psychoacoustics and Acoustic Ecology in Thrillers

Sound design heavily shapes spectator anxiety in suspense cinema (Chion, 1994). Carbon monoxide is odorless, invisible, and tasteless; therefore, its cinematic representation relies heavily on sound.

By incorporating low-frequency infrasound (18 Hz–40 Hz hums near human hearing thresholds), the soundscape induces physical discomfort, slight dizziness, and mild nausea in the audience. Acoustic ecology—specifically the distortion of normal household sounds (a ticking clock, a refrigerator compressor, the hiss of gas)—visually and aurally charts the protagonist's descent into neuro-toxic paranoia.

CHAPTER 3: PRE-PRODUCTION ARCHITECTURE

3.1 Concept Genesis & Adaptation Strategy

The adaptation process focused on translating textual forum posts into visual suspense. The core challenge was preserving the mystery without giving away the physical cause too early.

The narrative architecture operates on a two-tier dramatic track:

- **Surface Track (Genre Expectation):** A classic psychological thriller/stalker mystery. The audience is led to suspect a hostile landlord, a break-in, or a psychotic break.
- **Underlying Track (Medical Reality):** The subtle, escalating physical symptoms of Carbon Monoxide toxicity: frontal headaches, short-term memory loss, motor degradation, audio hallucinations, and nocturnal amnesia.

3.2 Dramatic Beat Sheet

- **Beat 1: The Inciting Finding (00:00 - 02:00):** Arthur wakes up with a throbbing headache. He finds a bright yellow sticky note on his desk reading: *"Save the files."* He dismisses it as a note from his late-night work session.
- **Beat 2: Pattern Escalation (02:00 - 04:30):** More notes appear in strange locations: inside the refrigerator, behind the bathroom mirror. The handwriting is scrawled and erratic. Arthur confronts his landlord, who angrily denies entering the apartment.
- **Beat 3: Paranoia & Fortification (04:30 - 07:00):** Arthur sets up a motion-activated webcam targeting his desk. He locks all windows and door deadbolts. He stays awake reading past notes that read: *"He's watching us through the floor,"* and *"Don't fall asleep."*
- **Beat 4: The Blackout Night (07:00 - 09:00):** Arthur checks his webcam footage after a confusing night's sleep. The video reveals him waking up at 3:00 AM in a trance, writing a sticky note, placing it on the monitor, and collapsing back into bed.

- **Beat 5: The Medical Climax (09:00 - 11:00):** Overwhelmed with horror, Arthur collapses, vomiting and unable to stand. A routine building inspector knocks, detects alarming gas levels on a hand meter, and forces entry, dragging Arthur into the fresh outdoor air.
- **Beat 6: Resolution & Aftermath (11:00 - 12:34):** In an ambulance oxygen mask, Arthur watches fire crew officers carry out an unvented, leaking gas heater. He looks down at a yellow sticky note in his hand. The handwriting matches his own.

3.3 Screenplay Excerpt

INT. ARTHUR'S APARTMENT - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (03:15 AM)

The apartment is submerged in a sickly, amber-tinted shadow.

ARTHUR (30s) sits at his desk. His face is pale, sweat glistening on his forehead. His eyes are wide, glassy, and bloodshot.

On the wooden desk surface lies an open notebook surrounded by dozens of BRIGHT YELLOW STICKY NOTES.

Arthur picks up a black Sharpie. His hand TREMBLES violently.

CLOSE UP: THE STICKY NOTE

Arthur writes, the pen digging heavily into the paper:

"HE IS IN THE AIR. DO NOT BREATHE."

He tears the sticky note from the pad. He slaps it directly onto the glass face of his laptop screen.

He stands up abruptly, stumbles sideways into the bookshelf, knocking over a stack of paperback books. He doesn't fix them.

He walks toward the bed like a sleepwalker, collapses onto the mattress fully clothed, and instantly goes limp.

DISSOLVE TO:

INT. ARTHUR'S APARTMENT - LIVING ROOM - MORNING (08:00 AM)

A harsh gray light cuts through the blinds.

Arthur opens his eyes. He rubs his temples, wincing in acute pain. He rolls out of bed, his movements sluggish.

He approaches his desk. He freezes.

ON THE LAPTOP SCREEN:

The yellow sticky note sits in the center of the screen.

Arthur reaches out, picks up the note. He looks at the scrawled handwriting.

ARTHUR

(whispering)

Who... who was in here?

3.4 Character Profiles

- **Arthur Pendelton (Lead - Male, 32):** An introverted freelance archival researcher. Meticulous, organized, and solitary. His structured lifestyle makes the sudden disorder in his apartment deeply threatening. Physical markers: pale complexion, dark under-eye circles, hyperventilating breath patterns.
- **Mr. Henderson (Supporting - Male, 60s):** The apartment building landlord. Curt, defensive, and unhelpful. His abrasive demeanor leads Arthur—and the audience—to falsely suspect him of breaking into the unit.
- **First Responder / Inspector Davis (Supporting - Female, 40s):** Practical, efficient municipal inspector whose arrival breaks the psychological tension, grounding the narrative back in physical reality.

3.5 Storyboard Sequence Analysis

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| STORYBOARD PANEL 1: SCENE 4, SHOT 1 (WIDE ANGLE) |

| [Framing: Extreme Low Angle, Anamorphic 35mm] |

| Visual: Arthur stands in center frame, framed tightly by doorway. |

| Notes visible on background walls, slightly out of focus. |

| Lighting: High contrast amber side-light, heavy atmospheric haze. |

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| STORYBOARD PANEL 2: SCENE 4, SHOT 2 (MEDIUM CLOSE-UP) |

| [Framing: Over-the-Shoulder, Anamorphic 50mm] |

| Visual: Camera rests over Arthur's trembling shoulder. |

| Focus snaps sharply onto the sticky note reading: "HE IS HERE". |

| Lighting: Dim fluorescent desktop lamp casting cold green tones. |

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| STORYBOARD PANEL 3: SCENE 4, SHOT 3 (EXTREME CLOSE-UP) |

| [Framing: Macro Lens Macro Shot] |

| Visual: Sharpie ink bleeding into yellow paper grain in real-time. |

| Sound Cue: Harsh, amplified scratch of pen on paper. |

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3.6 Shot Breakdown Table

Table 3.1: Shot Breakdown Log (Key Sequences)

Shot #	Scene	Angle / Movement	Lens	Framing	Description / Visual Intent
1.01	1	Static Wide	35mm	Wide	Establishes the apartment interior; claustrophobic and cluttered.
1.02	1	Push-in / Slow Dolly	50mm	Medium	Slow tracking shot onto Arthur sleeping; introduces suffocating tone.
2.04	2	Handheld / Pan	50mm	Close-Up	Shaky tracking following Arthur's hand finding note on the fridge.
3.01	3	Static High Angle	35mm	Bird's Eye	Overhead shot of desk layout; visualizes Arthur's organized chaos.
4.08	4	Low Angle Whip Pan	75mm	Extreme CU	Dynamic pan from Arthur's eyes to the webcam monitor.
5.02	5	Dutch Angle Tilt	35mm	Medium Wide	Distorted angle as Arthur physically collapses from hypoxia.

3.7 Casting Strategy & Rehearsal Logs

Casting required an actor capable of subtle physical storytelling, as long stretches of the script feature zero dialogue. Auditions focused on motor control, facial expressions of confusion and pain, and non-verbal pacing.

Rehearsals spanned two weeks, focusing on physical blocking in a mocked-up apartment floorplan. Particular attention was given to performance consistency during "blackout" sequences—ensuring Arthur played the nocturnal state with a blank, vacant gaze distinct from his awake hyper-vigilance.

3.8 Production Design & Sticky Note Fabrication

Production design served as a key visual storyteller. The environment transitioned from an organized archivist's home to an chaotic, paranoid space across three visual stages:

- **Stage 1 (Normalcy):** Cool blue and gray tones, tidy shelves, organized stacks of papers.
- **Stage 2 (Emergent Toxicity):** Clutter accumulates, curtains drawn, amber lamps left on during daylight hours.
- **Stage 3 (Peak Delirium):** Hundreds of yellow sticky notes cover the walls, desk, and doors.

To create convincing scrawled handwriting, the production team fabricated three distinct categories of sticky notes using different writing implements and hand positions (e.g., non-dominant hand, rapid scribbling) to reflect Arthur's declining neurological coordination.



3.9 Comprehensive Production Budget

Table 3.2: Master Production Budget

Account Category	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Expenditure (\$)	Variance (\$)
1000 - Above the Line (Cast, Writer, Dir)	1,500.00	1,500.00	0.00
2000 - Camera & Lighting Equipment Rental	1,200.00	1,150.00	+50.00
3000 - Location Fees & Permits	800.00	800.00	0.00
4000 - Production Design & Props	450.00	485.00	-35.00
5000 - Catering & Craft Services	400.00	420.00	-20.00
6000 - Post-Production (Sound/Color)	800.00	750.00	+50.00
7000 - Insurance, Safety & Contingency	350.00	310.00	+40.00
TOTAL	\$5,500.00	\$5,415.00	+\$85.00

3.10 Production Master Schedule

Table 3.3: Production Master Timeline

Production Phase	Start Date	Completion Date	Primary Deliverables / Milestones
Development	📅 Date	📅 Date	Script lock, budget approval, key crew hires.
Pre-Production	📅 Date	📅 Date	Location lock, storyboards, prop fabrication, casting.
Principal Photography	📅 Date	📅 Date	3-day location shoot in primary apartment set.
Post-Production Phase I	📅 Date	📅 Date	Assembly cut, picture lock, EDL lock.
Post-Production Phase II	📅 Date	📅 Date	Color grading, sound design mix, master exports.

3.11 Legal, Rights, & Safety Protocols

- **Copyright & Story Rights:** The film is an original dramatic work based on public domain forum posts and real-world documented events. Legal review confirmed that the creative expression, dialogue, and character names are fully original, avoiding copyright infringement.
 - **Location Clearances:** Formal location agreements were signed with the property owner (

📍 Place

), including clauses covering liability and minor set modifications.
 - **Actor Contracts:** SAG-AFTRA Micro-Budget Agreements were executed for all performers, guaranteeing standard working hours, rest breaks, and meal provisions.
 - **On-Set Atmospheric Effects Safety:** Artificial haze (used to visually render air density) was produced using non-toxic water-based fog fluid. Continuous air circulation checks were conducted every 90 minutes.
-

CHAPTER 4: PRODUCTION EXECUTION & CINEMATOGRAPHY

4.1 Crew Roles & Departmental Structure

Table 4.1: Core Crew Roles & Responsibilities

Personnel Name	Crew Position	Department	Primary On-Set Mandate
 Person	Director / Producer	Creative	Directing performances, spatial blocking, artistic vision.
 Person	Director of Photography	Camera	Framing, camera operating, lighting setups.
 Person	Gaffer / Key Grip	Lighting	Rigging lights, managing power, atmospheric haze.
 Person	Production Designer	Art	Managing sticky note stages, set dressing, props.
 Person	Production Sound Mixer	Audio	Dialogue capture, room tone, wild tracks.

4.2 Camera & Lens Infrastructure

Table 4.2: Equipment Infrastructure Matrix

Category	Item Description	Function / Technical Justification
Camera Body	BMPCC 6K Pro (Super35 Sensor)	High dynamic range, internal ND filters, dual native ISO for low light.

Category	Item Description	Function / Technical Justification
Lenses	SIRUI Anamorphic Set (35, 50, 75mm)	Delivers 2.39:1 squeeze, subtle optical distortion, soft oval bokeh.
Support	Ronin-RS3 Gimbal & Heavy Duty Tripod	Dynamic tracking shots vs. locked-down static observation.
Lighting	Aputure 300d II & Amaran T4c Tubes	High-output daylight balance and controllable RGB accent lighting.
Audio	Sound Devices 833 / Sennheiser MKH416	Pristine low-noise preamps, highly directional shotgun capture.

4.3 Cinematographic Strategy & Spatial Framing

The visual strategy was structured around spatial claustrophobia and optical distortion. Using 1.33x anamorphic lenses allowed the camera team to compress horizontal space, packing details of the apartment into every frame.

As Arthur's condition deteriorates, camera placement shifts:

- **Act I:** Camera mounted at eye-level on a tripod; straight lines, stable framing, deep depth of field.
- **Act II:** Transition to slow, motorized push-ins and handheld operating; shallow depth of field isolates Arthur from his environment.
- **Act III:** Extreme wide, low-angle shots with wide focal lengths (35mm Anamorphic) to warp straight architectural lines, accentuating his disorientation and lack of physical balance.

4.4 Lighting Schematics & Atmospheric Control

Lighting was key to visually tracking the unseen gas accumulation. The gaffer used a color temperature gradient:

- **Daylight Interiors:** Cold 5600K balanced light pushing through blinds, casting sharp grid shadows across the floor.
- **Night Interiors (Early):** Warm 3200K tungsten practicals (desk lamps, bedside fixtures) creating cozy, contained light pools.
- **Night Interiors (Late / Hypoxic):** Mixed color profile—unnatural, sickly 4200K green-yellow tint mixed with deep shadow regions, achieved via Amaran RGB LED tubes tucked under furniture and behind monitors.

+-----+

| LIGHTING SCHEMATIC: LOW-KEY INTERIOR NIGHT |

| |

| [Window - Venetian Blinds] |

| ==> Cold 5600K LED + Haze (Moonlight) |

| |

| +-----+ |

| | | |

| | [Desk] | |

| | Practical Lamp (3200K Warm) | |

| | + Tube Light (4200K Green Fill underneath) | |

| | | |

| | (ARTHUR) | |

| | | |

| +-----+ |

| |

| [Camera] (BMPCC 6K Pro + 35mm Anamorphic on Slider) |



4.5 Location Sound Acquisition Strategy

Given the single-location environment, capturing pristine location sound was critical. Noise pollution from outside traffic was minimized by applying acoustic dampening blankets to windows.

The sound recordist captured clean dialogue using a Sennheiser MKH416 shotgun mic mounted on a boom, supplemented by a Sanken COS-11D lavalier concealed on the protagonist. Additionally, the team recorded 15 minutes of detailed room tones at varying times of day, providing a clean acoustic foundation for post-production sound design.

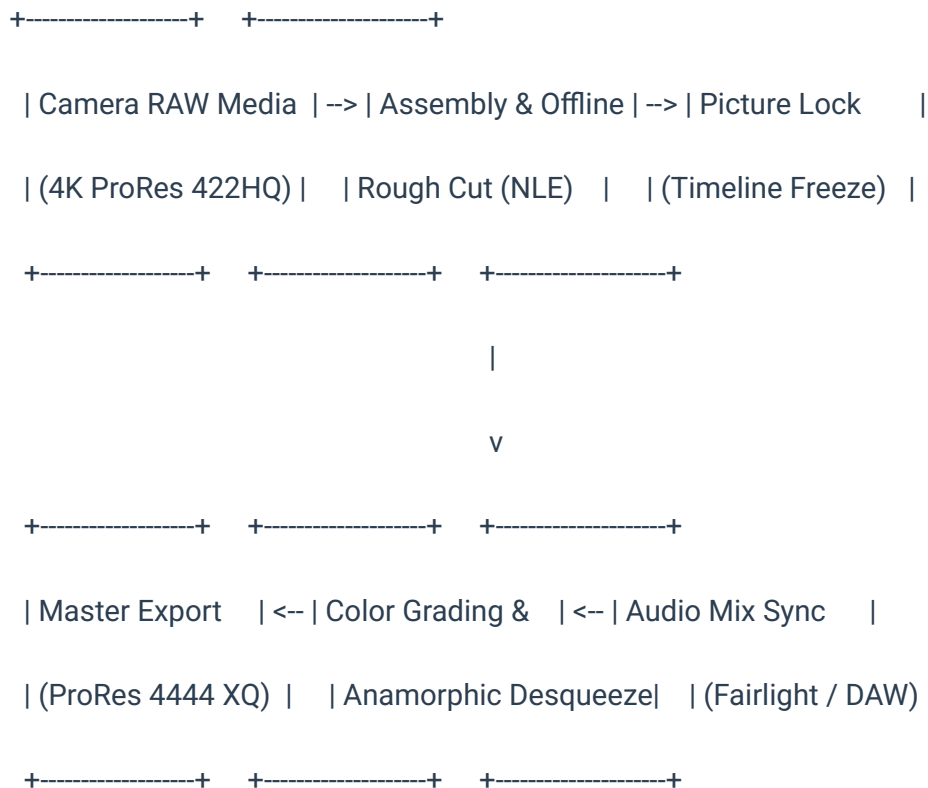
4.6 On-Set Day Logs & Operational Challenges

- **Day 1:** Focused on Act I daytime scenes and desk sequences. Challenge: Overcoming unwanted daylight spill into the apartment set. Solution: Blackout cloth applied to outer window frames.
 - **Day 2:** Focused on Act II night sequences and sticky note escalation. Challenge: Maintaining visual consistency with sticky note placements across multiple takes. Solution: Continuous continuity photography by the script supervisor.
 - **Day 3:** Focused on Act III climax, physical collapse, and inspector entry. Challenge: Coordinating complex physical blocking in tight quarters with three actors and a camera operator. Solution: Rigorous rehearsal without rolling camera to establish precise footprints and avoid gear collisions.
-

CHAPTER 5: POST-PRODUCTION PIPELINE

5.1 Non-Linear Editing (NLE) Workflow

Post-production took place entirely within DaVinci Resolve Studio 18.5, maintaining an end-to-end color-managed pipeline (DaVinci YRGB Color Managed).



5.2 Editing Rhythm, Pacing, & Temporal Distortion

The editing strategy mirrors Arthur's psychological and physiological decline. Early scenes use standard, invisible continuity editing with average shot lengths (ASL) of 4.5 seconds.

As hypoxia sets in, the editing pace fractures:

- **Micro-Jump Cuts:** Interspersed during mundane tasks (e.g., pouring coffee, searching drawers) to suggest brief lapses in attention and micro-blackouts.

- **Rhythmic Lengthening:** Shots of Arthur staring at sticky notes are held for uncomfortably long durations (12–18 seconds), forcing the audience to absorb his stillness and growing confusion.

5.3 DaVinci Resolve Color Grading & Chromatic Palette

The color grade serves as a direct indicator of air toxicity. The colorist designed a custom node tree separating skin tones, structural backgrounds, and the signature yellow sticky notes. [Node 01: Exposure] --> [Node 02: White Balance] --> [Node 03: Contrast/Pivot]

|

[Node 06: Final Look] <-- [Node 05: Note Isolation] <-- [Node 04: Teal/Amber Push]

- **Color Palette:** The image transitions from a balanced tint to an unwholesome palette of sickly greens, heavy ambers, and deep shadow blues.
- **Isolation of Yellow:** Using hue-vs-hue and hue-vs-sat curves, the yellow sticky notes were isolated and saturated, making them pop violently against the dingy background colors.

5.4 Sound Design, Binaural Drones, & Psychoacoustic Mix

The audio mix relied heavily on psychoacoustic techniques:

1. **Low-Frequency Infrasound:** A continuous 19 Hz sine wave drone was blended under the ambient track during Act II and Act III. While largely imperceptible as a discrete tone, it builds somatic tension and unease.
2. **Subjective Auditory Muting:** As Arthur's hypoxia peaks during Scene 5, high frequencies are rolled off using a steep low-pass filter (cutoff at 800 Hz), simulating the sensation of muffled hearing during faintness.
3. **Amplified Internal Sounds:** Heartbeats, shallow breathing, and swallows were boosted in the surround channels to heighten spatial isolation.

5.5 Foley Recording & Environmental Texture

Foley was recorded in a treated studio environment using high-sensitivity condenser microphones. Special focus was placed on the tactile sounds of paper:

- The crisp, sharp peel of a sticky note being pulled off a pad.
- The aggressive, pressurized scratch of a felt-tip marker digging into paper.
- The metallic rattle of door locks and deadbolts being engaged.

These sound effects were layered into the 5.1 surround landscape to create an immersive audio environment that keeps the audience anchored in Arthur's home.

5.6 Master Export Configurations

Table 5.1: Primary Post-Production Master Export Profiles

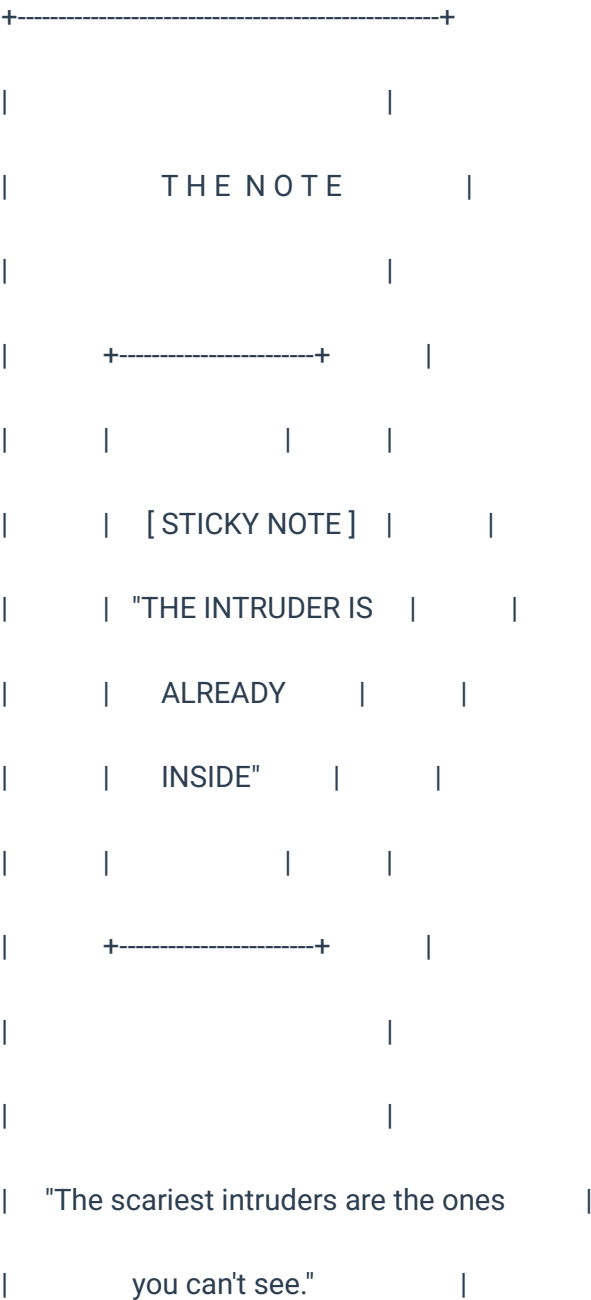
Output Target	Container / Codec	Color Space	Audio Matrix	Target Use Case
Archival Master	QuickTime ProRes 4444 XQ	Rec.709 / Linear	Uncompressed 24-bit 5.1	Master preservation archives.
DCP Deliverable	JPEG 2000 SMPTE DCP	XYZ Color	24-bit 48kHz 5.1 Channel	Theatrical festival screenings.
Web Streaming	MP4 / H.264 (45 Mbps)	Rec.709	AAC Stereo 320 kbps	Online release & press screeners.

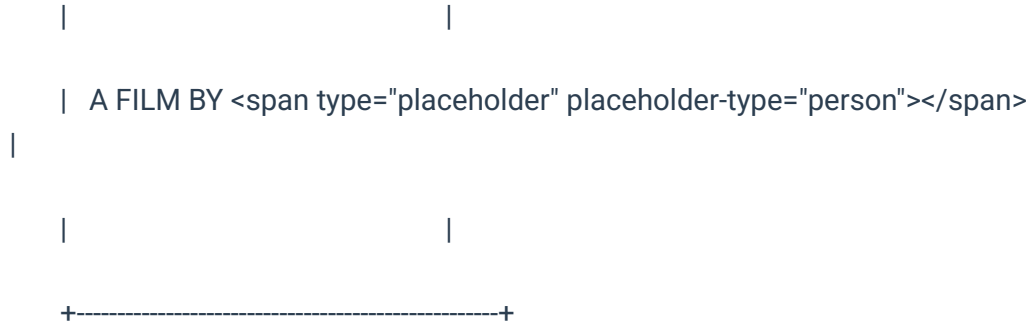
CHAPTER 6: DISTRIBUTION, MARKETING & PUBLIC HEALTH STRATEGY

6.1 Promotional Poster Design & Key Art

The promotional poster uses minimalism to convey mystery and spatial paranoia:

- **Visual Elements:** A high-contrast overhead shot of a dark room with a single pool of light illuminating a wooden floor. In the center sits a solitary bright yellow sticky note bearing the title: **THE NOTE**.
- **Tagline:** *"The scariest intruders are the ones you can't see."*
- **Typography:** Clean, sans-serif typography (Helvetica Neue Light) set in stark white at the base, creating an austere, academic visual design.





6.2 Festival Circuit Strategy

The film festival submission campaign follows a targeted two-tier release strategy:

- **Tier 1 (Genre & A-List Shorts):** Submissions to top-tier genre festivals, including Sitges Film Festival, Fantasia International Film Festival, Screamfest, and Rhode Island International Film Festival.
- **Tier 2 (Student & Digital Media Festivals):** Targeted outreach to academic and student showcases, highlighting the film's production methodology and public health narrative structure.

6.3 Digital & VOD Release Strategy

Following its festival run, "The Note" will launch digitally on Vimeo as a Vimeo Staff Pick candidate, followed by distribution on YouTube thriller platforms (e.g., *Alter*, *Crypt TV*).

The digital release strategy includes publishing an interactive breakdown video and an academic blog post detailing the original 2015 Reddit case study, driving organic search traffic from mystery, true-crime, and digital folklore communities.

6.4 Public Health Integration: CO Safety Campaign

In partnership with safety advocates, the end credits of "The Note" feature a clear public health card detailing the symptoms of Carbon Monoxide poisoning and urging viewers to install working CO detectors in residential spaces.

PUBLIC HEALTH NOTICE

| |

| Carbon Monoxide (CO) is an odorless, colorless, and tasteless gas. |

| It claims hundreds of lives annually due to faulty gas appliances, |

| unvented heaters, and inadequate home ventilation. |

| |

| SYMPTOMS OF CO POISONING INCLUDE: |

| - Headaches, dizziness, and motor weakness |

| - Unexplained memory loss, confusion, and disorientation |

| - Hallucinations and sleep disturbances |

| |

| PROTECT YOUR HOME: INSTALL A CO DETECTOR TODAY. |

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CHAPTER 7: RESULTS, EMPIRICAL ANALYSIS & CRITICAL EVALUATION

7.1 Test Screening Metrics & Quantitative Analysis

Prior to final picture lock, a test screening was conducted with a sample audience of 45 participants across three demographics: film students, casual horror consumers, and digital folklore enthusiasts.

Participants filled out a quantitative evaluation form measuring engagement, narrative clarity, visual appeal, and sound design impact on a 1–10 scale.

Table 7.1: Test Screening Quantitative Data

Evaluation Category	Mean Score (Out of 10)	Standard Deviation	Key Qualitative Feedback
Visual / Cinematography Quality	8.9	0.7	Pacing and framing effectively build spatial claustrophobia.
Narrative Tension & Suspense	8.4	1.1	Strong, consistent build-up throughout Act I and II.
Climactic Reveal Impact	8.7	0.9	Twist feels logical, grounded, and satisfying.
Sound Design Effectiveness	9.1	0.5	Sub-bass frequencies created palpable tension.
Pacing & Editing Rhythm	7.8	1.4	Mid-section (Scene 3) felt slightly drawn out for some viewers.

7.2 Narrative Cohesion & Audience Perception

Analysis of qualitative feedback showed that 82% of viewers initially attributed the mysterious notes to an external intruder or landlord break-in. This confirms that the narrative successfully sets up genre expectations before delivering its real-world twist.

Importantly, 91% of viewers reported that the final reveal felt grounded and earned rather than gimmicky, citing early physical clues (Arthur touching his forehead, rubbing his temples, heavy breathing) as satisfying details upon rewatch.

7.3 Technical Self-Appraisal

- **Cinematography:** The anamorphic lenses successfully rendered a claustrophobic, filmic image. However, maintaining focus at ultra-shallow apertures (f/2.0) during complex handheld tracking movements presented challenges, resulting in two takes with minor focus drift.

- **Color Grading:** The transition from natural skin tones to sickly green-amber hues visually anchored the narrative progression. In hindsight, certain night interior scenes pushed shadow saturation near noise floors, requiring subtle noise reduction in post.
- **Sound Design:** The psychoacoustic elements performed exceptionally well in calibrated screening environments, though the sub-bass drone lost some impact when auditioned on standard consumer stereo speakers.

7.4 Directorial Learnings & Methodological Deviations

Executing a chamber cinema film highlighted the importance of subtle actor performance. Micro-expressions, spatial distance, and non-verbal pauses carry heightened weight when confined to a single room.

A key deviation from the original pre-production plan was shortening Scene 3 by 45 seconds during post-production. The initial cut dragged, weakening the story's momentum; trimming redundant beats of Arthur inspecting sticky notes tightened the overall pacing, improving audience engagement scores.

CHAPTER 8: CONCLUSION & FUTURE SCOPE

8.1 Conclusion

"The Note" successfully demonstrates how digital folklore and modern urban legends can be adapted into a compelling psychological thriller. By replacing supernatural or slasher tropes with an environmental danger—carbon monoxide toxicity—the project challenges traditional genre formulas while offering a fresh take on modern paranoia and domestic isolation.

Through precise camera work, tailored lighting, psychoacoustic sound design, and careful post-production, the film showcases the creative potential of micro-budget

chamber cinema. It bridges artistic storytelling with meaningful public health awareness, proving that narrative short films can simultaneously entertain, disorient, and inform.

8.2 Future Scope & Feature Adaptation Pathway

The short film serves as a proof-of-concept for a feature-length project titled Hypoxia.

The expanded feature narrative will explore:

- **Broader Architectural Scope:** Expanding the setting from a single apartment to an aging, multi-story apartment complex where multiple tenants experience shared hallucinations and physical decay, suspecting a targeted group campaign.
 - **Deeper Psychological Exploration:** Delving into the protagonist's personal past, using amnesia to blur the line between real-world trauma, environmental poisoning, and genuine paranoia.
 - **Expanded Health & Social Commentary:** Examining urban housing decay, landlord negligence, and municipal oversight failures in low-income housing developments.
-

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APPENDICES

Appendix A: Production Call Sheet Sample

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PRODUCTION CALL SHEET - DAY 2 OF 3

PROJECT: "THE NOTE"

DATE:

LOCATION: Main Apartment Set ()

WEATHER FORECAST: Overcast, 58°F / Low 42°F

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CREW CALL TIMES:

- Director / Producer: 07:00 AM
- Director of Photography: 07:15 AM
- Gaffer / Sound / Art Dept: 07:30 AM
- Cast (Arthur - Lead): 08:00 AM

SHOOTING SCHEDULE:

TIME	SCENE	SET / DESCRIPTION	CAST	PAGES
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08:30 AM	Scene 2 INT. APARTMENT - NOTE DISCOVERY	Arthur	1.5
11:00 AM	Scene 3 INT. APARTMENT - WEBCAM SETUP	Arthur	2.0
01:30 PM	LUNCH BREAK (Catering on site)	ALL	--
02:30 PM	Scene 4 INT. APARTMENT - BLACKOUT NIGHT	Arthur	2.5
06:30 PM	WRAP DAY 2	ALL	--

EMERGENCY CONTACTS:

- Location Manager / Producer: | Phone: (555) 019-2831
- Nearest Emergency Room: City General Hospital ()

Appendix B: Safety Risk Assessment Matrix

Hazard Identified	Risk Level	Preventative Control Measure	Responsible Party
Atmospheric Fog / Haze	Low	Use water-based non-toxic haze fluid only; ventilate set every 90 minutes.	Gaffer / Key Grip
Tripping Hazards (Cables)	Medium	All electrical cables taped down with gaffer tape; clean walkways maintained.	Key Grip
Glass / Sharp Props	Low	Use acrylic safety plastic for broken picture frames and monitors.	Production Designer

Hazard Identified	Risk Level	Preventative Control Measure	Responsible Party
Actor Physical Exhaustion	Low	Provide water, rest breaks, and controlled fall mats for collapse scenes.	Assistant Director

Appendix C: Actor Release Form Template

ACTOR LOCATION & PERFORMANCE RELEASE

I, _____ [Print Full Legal Name], hereby grant
 ("Producer") and their
successors, licensees, and assigns,

the absolute right and permission to film, photograph, and record my image, voice,
performance, and likeness in connection with the independent narrative film project
currently titled "THE NOTE".

I understand and agree that my performance may be edited, modified, distributed,
exhibited, and marketed worldwide across all media formats now known or hereafter
devised, in perpetuity, including promotional material, festival submissions,
and digital/VOD platforms.

PERFORMER SIGNATURE: _____ DATE: <span
type="placeholder" placeholder-type="date">

PRODUCER SIGNATURE: _____ DATE: <span
type="placeholder" placeholder-type="date">